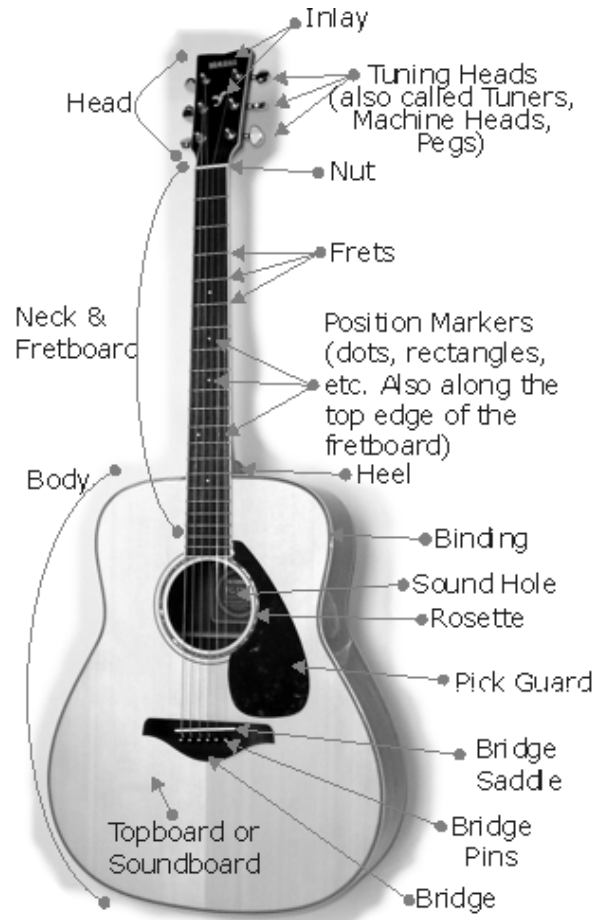


PARTS OF THE GUITAR - ACOUSTIC

Whether you start with an acoustic guitar or an electric guitar, it is wise to be able to identify all the guitar parts with their correct names. Take some time to memorize all the part names and you will find it easier to understand their function later on. The type of guitar shown below is a steel string acoustic.

PART NAMES AND FUNCTION

- **Neck** – the neck is the entire length between the guitar *body* and the *head* of the guitar
- **Fretboard** – not to be confused with the *neck*, the fretboard is the section of the neck where you place your fingers on the strings. Usually made of rosewood or mahogany
- **Head** – the end of the *neck* holding the *tuning heads*
- **Frets** – the metal wire across the *fretboard* you will use to play notes
- **Strings** – normally six (can be seven or more) strings run down the *neck* made of either steel or nylon (depending on the guitar type)
- **Body** – the part of the guitar you will rest on your lap while playing. Can be made out of a wide range of woods and are many different shapes and sizes
- **Bridge** – where the end of the strings are held on the guitar *body*
- **Sound hole** – allows the sound to project out from the guitar *body*
- **Nut** – the fixed bar that holds the strings in place at the end of the *neck*
- **Tuning Heads** – called a range of different names but all do the same basic job- allow you to tune the guitar
- **Position Markers** – most guitars have some type of markers (for example, dots, diamonds, rectangles, etc) to help you recognize your position on the *fretboard*
- **Pick Guard** – a plastic sheet on the guitar to protect the guitar *body* from scratches. Old guitars without pick guards can have very obvious worn out scratches from repeated strumming over the years
- **Rosette** – decorative inlay around the *sound hole*.
- **Binding** – decorative edging on the guitar *body*.
- **Heel** – the end of the *neck* where it connects to the guitar *body*. The heel gives strength to the neck and body to resist against the force of the strings
- **Soundboard** – the top layer of the *body*. A range of different woods can be used (for example, spruce or red cedar) which greatly affect the sound
- **Truss Rod** (not shown) – a rod contained inside the *neck* in some guitars to provide resistance against the force of the strings. The truss rod can be adjusted to change the bow of the neck
- **Bridge Pins** – used to hold the ends of the strings in place into the *bridge* (only on some guitars)
- **Bridge Saddle** – holds the strings in place at the *bridge*.



PARTS OF THE GUITAR - ELECTRIC

Electric guitars can come in every shape imaginable and there are a huge range of different parts available. Although electric guitars can have many different type of parts, the basic layout and functions are normally all very similar.

PART NAMES AND FUNCTION

- **Neck** – the neck is the entire length between the guitar *body* and the *head* of the guitar
- **Fretboard** – not to be confused with the *neck*, the fretboard is the section of the neck where you place your fingers on the strings. Usually made of rosewood, mahogany or maple
- **Head** – the end of the *neck* holding the *tuning heads*
- **Frets** – the metal wire across the *fretboard* you will use to play notes
- **Strings** – normally six (can be seven or more) strings run down the *neck*
- **Body** – the part of the guitar you will rest on your lap while playing. Can be made out of a wide range of woods and many different shapes and sizes
- **Bridge** – where the end of the strings are held on the guitar *body*. Many different variations are available with electric guitars
- **Whammy Bar** – available on some guitars. Connects to the *bridge* and allows the pitch of the strings to be lowered (or sometimes raised)
- **Nut** – the fixed bar that holds the strings in place at the end of the *neck*
- **Tuning Heads** – called a range of different names but all do the same basic job- allow you to tune the guitar
- **Position Markers** – most guitars have some type of markers (for example, dots, diamonds, rectangles, etc) to help you recognize your position on the *fretboard*
- **Pick Guard** – a plastic sheet on some guitars to protect the guitar *body* from scratches. Old guitars without pick guards can have very obvious worn out scratches from repeated strumming over the years
- **Truss Rod** (not shown) – a rod contained inside the *neck* in some guitars to provide resistance against the force of the strings. The truss rod can be adjusted to change the bow of the neck
- **Cutaway** – allows greater access to the higher *frets*
- **Pickups** – the vibration of the strings is captured in the electromagnetic pickups. A wide range of types are available and all have a huge impact on tone
- **Pickup Selector** – allows you to change between the different pickups and even combinations of pickups
- **Input Jack** – allows you to connect the guitar to an amp. Sometime people call it an 'output jack'
- **Volume & Tone Knobs** – allow you to adjust the guitar's volume and tone
- **Strap Buttons** – two buttons that allow you to attach a strap so you can play while standing up

